

UNIVERSITY OF EXCELLENCE

DATA PROTECTION AND PRIVACY POLICY

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1. Scope and Purpose

This policy governs the collection, processing, storage, and sharing of personal data of students, staff, and stakeholders. The university complies with the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR) and the Data Protection Act 2018. The Data Protection Officer (DPO) oversees compliance and can be reached at dpo@university.ac.uk.

2. Data Collection Principles

Personal data shall be collected only for specified, explicit, and legitimate purposes. Data collected must be adequate, relevant, and limited to what is necessary (data minimisation). Students will be informed of the purpose of data collection via a Privacy Notice at the point of enrolment. Sensitive data (health, religion, ethnicity) requires explicit consent before processing.

3. Data Retention and Deletion

Student records are retained for 6 years after graduation or last enrolment. Exam scripts and assessment records are kept for 2 years after the end of the academic year. Personal data will be securely deleted or anonymised once the retention period expires.

4. Student Rights

Right to access: Students can request a copy of their personal data via a Subject Access Request (SAR).
Right to rectification: Students can request correction of inaccurate or incomplete data.
Right to erasure (right to be forgotten): Data will be erased upon request unless a legal obligation to retain exists.
Right to data portability: Students can request transfer of their data to another institution.
Requests must be fulfilled within 30 calendar days.

5. Data Security

All personal data must be stored on encrypted university-managed systems. Staff must not store student data on personal devices or unapproved cloud services. Any data breach must be reported to the DPO within 24 hours of discovery. The university will notify affected individuals and the ICO within 72 hours of a confirmed breach.